

(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

- 7.b) Culture is unique to human beings. Do you agree? Present arguments in favour and against the statement. (15 marks)

Culture is not made part of Environment - Herskovits

Within the framework of this definition culture would not be unique to humans because primates can also create, yet culture maybe considered unique because

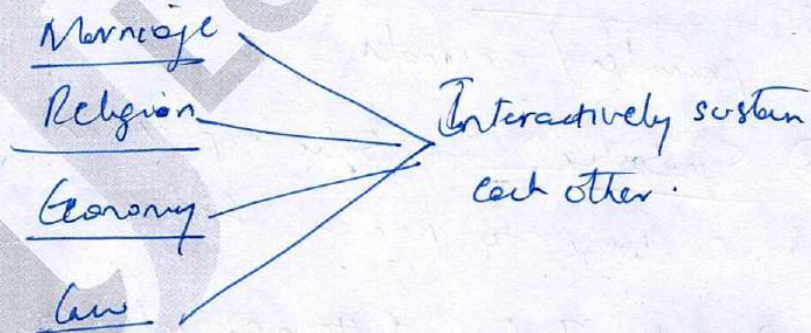
- ① Ideational : Only humans conceptualise & ideate
- ② Transmitted : Not instinctual like primates / animals
- ③ Symbolic : Symbolic expression is exclusive to human beings
- ④ Integrated : Patterned into a mosaic that can only be identified by other humans
- ⑤ needs external impetus for propagation
- culture does not automatically flow

→ ~~Causes~~ for culture being exclusive

- ① Brain capacity in qualitative aspects, not quantitative
- ② Ability to transmit & communicate symbolically
→ creation of syntax & vocabulary
- ③ Thumb opposition

Uniquely placed to hold objects
↓
dexterity

④ Social institutions created :



Culture therefore is super organic
[Kroeber based on Spencer] and is
exclusive to human beings

Arguments against

① Language learnt by chimpanzee at Captivity in USA
Symbolic communication isn't exclusive

② Even gorillas have society &
stratification in society → Silverback gorilla
 → Mother gorilla

③ Tool use found by orangutans as well
honey stick dipping

④ Feeling of community, well entrenched

As apex species, Humans uniquely have culture as Jane Goodall puts it
 "Man's first fryst with culture was discovery of broken & headed femur because it implied that he was taken care of."